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Statement of Purpose, MPS Communication Design, Parsons School of Design (Fall 2027)

I still remember standing inside the Mir Hassan Ali Palace in Hyderabad with my camera, tracing the geometry of a jharoka that had been carved sometime in the 1840s and was slowly falling apart. That image, more than anything else, is why I want to study Communication Design at Parsons. I do not see textile design and communication design as two separate paths I am choosing between. For me they have always been the same question asked in different materials, how do you take something that carries meaning, whether it is a carved window or a piece of oral history, and make it legible to someone who was never in the room where it happened.

I finished my BFA in Textile Design in 2025 at SABS University in Jamshoro. My thesis, *Threads of Time*, took architectural ornament from the Talpur era and moved it through digital documentation, print development, and eventually a sculptural metal corset built from motifs that no longer exist anywhere except in that one building. The hardest part was never the printing or the construction. It was sequencing the information so someone looking at the final piece could feel the history in it without me there to explain it. That is a communication problem before it is a craft problem, and it is why I applied to Parsons the first time. I was waitlisted that cycle, and in an interview and the emails that followed, Andrew Leclair told me plainly what the portfolio was missing, attention to detail, originality, conceptual thinking, and real interaction design. I spent the year since building work that answers that instead of defending what I already had.

MIR, What Remains. is a fragrance and communication campaign I built from scratch off the back of that feedback. It reuses the doorway and ceiling drawings from my thesis, but the wordmark, the packaging system, the three typographic posters, the motion study, and an interactive postcard maker are decisions I had to make and defend on their own, not textile decisions wearing a different medium. *Mir's Café* pushed further into work I had never built before, identity, packaging, an ordering app, an out of home campaign, and social content, all made to hold together as one voice across formats I had to learn as I went. Both are on my site now, which I coded myself, alongside the freelance pattern work I kept taking on.

Watching how differently a heritage motif reads on silk versus on a scrolling web page taught me something my training alone could not. A pattern on fabric asks to be touched and worn. The same pattern on a screen asks to be navigated, and if the interaction is clumsy the meaning gets lost no matter how good the research behind it is. That gap is what pulled me toward Communication Design over staying purely in textiles, and it is what I built *MIR* and *Mir's Café* to close.

At Parsons I want to keep working with the Talpur Haveli material, but push it into interactive and editorial formats, archives that let a viewer move through architectural motifs the way I moved through the building, and typography drawn from the geometry of the carvings rather than imposed on top of them. I am still new to motion and time based work and want it trained properly. I want to be in a room with people from graphic design, illustration, and interaction design who will push back on my instincts, because most of my feedback until this year came from people trained the same way I was.

What I bring is a research process built on fieldwork rather than reference images, and a stubbornness about not letting cultural material get flattened into decoration, which I see happen constantly with South Asian textile heritage.

My plan after graduating is to start a small studio in Pakistan that works on documentation and communication design for heritage sites and craft communities left out of that conversation, places like Talpur Haveli that never get institutional preservation funding but still hold real visual and material knowledge. I could not build that credibly straight out of a textile degree, and I could not build it credibly off a waitlisted application either. I need the systems thinking and the exposure to how design institutions operate in New York to pitch this work and have it taken seriously. I used the year to make the work Andrew described, and I am applying again because I believe it holds up.